UNIVERSITY OF ABUJA

Department of Physics · Postgraduate Journey Portal

Student User Guide

Your postgraduate journey, step by step

This guide explains how to use the portal from registration to completion: how to read your dashboard, submit documents, work with your supervisors and know what to do at each of the 16 stages.

Document	Details
Version	November 2026 (reflects the portal after the supervision, journey-tracker and examiner-workload updates)
Audience	Postgraduate students (MSc, MPhil, PhD)
Portal address	The web-app link sent to you by the PG Coordinator (PGC)
Help	Help & FAQ page inside the portal, or an Inquiry to the PGC

In this guide

- About the portal and your journey
- Signing in, passwords and notifications
- Registering and getting approved
- Your dashboard
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- Submitting documents
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- Quick reference

1. About the portal and your journey

What the portal does

The PG Journey Portal is where the Department of Physics tracks your postgraduate programme. It tells you which stage you are at, what you must do next, who must approve it, and keeps all your submissions, meetings, messages and examiner outcomes in one place.

The 16 stages and 5 phases

Your journey has 16 stages grouped in 5 phases. **Gates** (marked ◆) are stages where an outcome decides what happens next. Stage 2 applies to MSc students only.

Phase	Stages	Name
1	1–3	Coursework & Research Preparation
2	4–7	Proposal Stage
3	8–10	Research Execution & Progress
4	11–13	Thesis Verification & External Examination
5	14–16	Post-Defence Corrections & Completion

Stage reference

#	Stage	What happens	Who acts
1	Admission	Registration and university orientation completed.	Student, PGC
2	Lecture Attendance	Required lectures (MSc students only).	Student
3	Supervisor Allocation	Main and Co-Supervisor assigned.	HoD / PGC
4	Title Approval	Thesis title submitted and approved by both supervisors.	Student, supervisors
5	Proposal Submission	Research Proposal uploaded, format-checked and approved.	Student, Inspector
6	Defence Readiness	Signed Proposal Defence Form uploaded, or readiness approved in the system.	Student, supervisors, PGC
7	Proposal Defence ◆	Defence at the monthly seminar; outcome recorded. **Gate.**	PGC
8	Progress Report Intent	Approval to present the progress report.	Supervisors, PGC
9	Internal Examiner Assignment	An Internal Examiner from another department is appointed.	HoD
10	Progress Presentation ◆	Presentation (PPTX) checked and approved. **Gate.**	Student, Inspector
11	Final Examination Intent	Approval for the final examination.	Supervisors, PGC

#	Stage	What happens	Who acts
12	Thesis Submission ◆	Thesis uploaded; format and similarity checks; approval. **Gate.**	Student, Inspector
13	External Examiner Assignment ◆	An External Examiner from another university is appointed. **Gate.**	HoD
14	Examiners' Comments	Examiner comments, comment-by-comment response and final corrections.	Student
15	Final Compliance ◆	Supervisors endorse; Inspector and PGC approve the final copy. **Gate.**	Supervisors, PGC, Inspector
16	Signed Copies and Completion	Signed copies submitted to the PGC; journey complete.	Student, PGC

> **Tip** The Home page animation shows the same journey: each stage lights up in turn, and the banner at the bottom names the stage and phase.

2. Signing in, passwords and notifications

Sign in for the first time

1. Open the portal link and choose **Login**.
2. Enter your **registration number** then the one-time password sent to you by email.
3. You are asked to choose a new password. It must be 8–128 characters, contain at least one letter and one number, and must not be your registration number or a common password.

> **Good to know** After 5 wrong attempts the account is locked for 15 minutes. Your session ends automatically after about 6 hours; just sign in again.

Forgot your password

1. On the sign-in page choose **Forgot password?** enter your registration number and press **Email me a code**.
2. A 6-digit code is sent to the email address on your account. It expires after 30 minutes.
3. Enter the code and your new password. You can request a code up to 3 times per hour. If no email arrives, check your spam folder or contact the PGC.

Notifications and email settings

- The **bell** (top right) shows unread updates. Opening it marks them as read.
- Red numbers on menu tabs show how many items are waiting for you.
- On **Help & FAQ**, set Email notifications to Instant, Daily digest or Off (bell only). Account and security emails are always sent.

- Use the moon icon to switch between light and dark theme, **Change password** to update your password, and **Sign out** when you finish, especially on a shared computer.
- Emails come from a no-reply address. Do not reply to them; use Messages or Inquiries in the portal instead.

Change your email address

1. Open **Help & FAQ** and find the **My account** card.
2. Type the new address and press **Send confirmation code**. The 6-digit code goes to the NEW address, so the change only happens if you can open it.
3. Enter the code (valid for 30 minutes) and press **Confirm new email**.

> **Note** An address that another account already uses is refused. You can request a code up to 3 times per hour.

3. Registering and getting approved

Register as a new student

1. From the public site choose **Register**.
2. Enter your registration number (for example UA/pg2026/003531 or 26/408PHYX/040), names, gender, phone, email, faculty, department, programme and specialisation.
3. Upload a passport photograph (JPG or PNG; large photos are resized). You may also attach your admission letter (PDF, JPG or PNG, up to 3 MB). Only the PGC and HoD can open it.
4. Submit. Your registration waits for PGC approval.

> **Note** Use an email address no other account uses. Check progress any time with **Check Status**. You will be emailed the decision and a one-time password. Your academic session is set automatically from your registration number.

4. Your dashboard

What you see

- Your profile card, session, **Main Supervisor** and **Co-Supervisor**, and your thesis title with its status.
- The **PG Journey** card: a progress bar and a visual tracker of all 16 stages. Completed stages are ticked, your current stage pulses, and gate stages carry a gold **G** badge.
- A **gate card** appears when you reach a gate stage (7, 10, 12, 13 or 15). It explains the possible outcomes and what each means for you.
- **To move on from this stage**: a checklist of what you still need to do, with ticks for items the portal can verify (for example an approved Research Proposal).
- **Programme time limit** (when switched on by the PGC): months used and months left.

- Announcements, upcoming deadlines, seminars, supervision meetings, action items, monthly check-in and supervisor reviews.

Useful buttons

- **Add deadlines to calendar** downloads deadlines to your calendar.
- **My timeline** shows everything that has happened on your journey.
- **Download my card** gives your student card.
- To change your passport photo, choose a JPG or PNG under 1 MB in your profile card and press **Update Photo**.

Ask for a stage update

1. If your stage is wrong, go to **My Journey Stage**, choose the stage you are at and add an optional note.
2. Press **Request stage update**. Only one request can wait at a time; the PGC approves or declines it and you are notified.

5. Thesis title

Enter and confirm your title

1. The title box opens once you reach stage 6 (if you are already past it, it is open now).
2. Type your full title (10–400 characters) and press **Save title**. It shows *Awaiting confirmation*. You can edit and save again; each save returns it to awaiting confirmation.
3. Once the PGC confirms it, it is locked until stage 11.
4. If it must change earlier, use **Need to change the confirmed title?** give the new wording and your reason, then **Send title change request**. If approved, the new wording replaces the old one and stays confirmed.

Title approval by supervisors

Stage 4 (Title Approval) uses the approval request described under *Requesting approvals* below: both supervisors approve your proposed title before you can proceed to proposal submission.

6. Submitting documents

Submit a document

1. Under **New Submission** (Dashboard or My Submissions) choose the **Type**. Download the official templates first from **Download Templates** if needed.
2. Upload a PDFor DOCX file (up to 50 MB) or paste a Google Drive file link. Press **Submit**.
3. Not ready? Press **Save as draft** instead. A draft is private to you and not seen by reviewers.

Format check For Research Proposal, Progress Report, Final Thesis/Dissertation and Final Correction, Word files get an automatic check: left margin 4.0 cm, other margins 2.5 cm, and in-text citations matched against the reference list. Submit Word (.docx) where you can; PDFs cannot be checked automatically. Use **Check my formatting** before you submit.

Document types and stage rules

Document	When it can be submitted
Research Proposal	Stage 5 (Proposal Submission)
Signed Proposal Defence Form	Stage 6 (Route A for defence readiness)
Progress Report / Progress Presentation (PPTX)	Stages 9–10
Internal Examiner and Other Observations	Before stage 11 (must be submitted before the thesis goes for external examination)
Final Thesis/Dissertation	Stage 12 (Thesis Submission)
External Examiner Comments, Comment-by-Comment Responses, Final Correction	From stage 14 (Examiners' Comments)

Drafts

1. Open **My Submissions**. Drafts show the status *Draft* and a link to the saved file.
2. Press **Submit for review** when ready. Stage rules and the format check run at this moment, and your supervisors are given access.
3. Press **Delete** to remove a draft. Only drafts can be deleted.

Track a submission and resubmit

1. **My Submissions** lists each submission with its status: Submitted, Under Review, Changes Requested, Approved or Rejected, plus Inspector Comments and Supervisor Notes.
2. If it is *Rejected* or *Changes Requested*, read the numbered comments, fix your document and press **Resubmit file** (or **Use a link**). It returns to *Submitted*.
3. Approval of your Research Proposal, Progress Report or Final Thesis moves your stage forward automatically and you are notified.

Feedback thread on a submission

Each submission has a **Feedback** button. It opens a written thread where you, your supervisors and reviewers can comment on that document. Posting a comment notifies the other side. Use it for specific questions about one document; use Messages for general conversation.

7. Requesting approvals

Approval requests

Several stages need a formal approval before you can move on: **Title Approval**, **Proposal Defence Readiness**, **Progress Report Presentation** and **Final Examination**.

1. Open the relevant card on your dashboard and choose your **preferred month**; add an optional note.
2. Send the request. Your Main and Co-Supervisor each approve (or return it with a reason). For readiness, progress and final examination requests, the PGC then approves.
3. Track the status on the card. A *Returned* request can be corrected and resent; you can **Withdraw** a request that is still waiting.
4. When fully approved, your stage advances and you are notified.

> **Early requests** If you request before the usual stage, the portal warns you which stage is normal. You can still submit; the PGC will decide.

8. Working with your supervisors

Messages

Replies appear in the same thread.

1. Press **Message my supervisors** on the Dashboard.
2. Type a message, optionally attach a PDF, Word, PNG or JPG file (under 5 MB), and press **Send**. Both supervisors are notified by bell and email.

Supervision meetings

1. When your supervisor schedules a meeting, you get a notification and an email with a calendar file. It also shows on your Dashboard with date, time and venue; press **Add to calendar** to download it.
2. Before the meeting, press **Add my agenda points** and list what you want to discuss. Your supervisors are notified.
3. After the meeting your supervisor records notes and action points. Read them under **Supervision Meetings** and press **Acknowledge notes**.
4. A cancelled meeting is shown crossed out and you are notified.

Action items

Action items from meetings appear in the **Action items** card with who owns each one and its due date. Press **Mark done** on yours when complete. Overdue items are highlighted and you receive reminders. Items owned by your supervisor are shown so you can see what to expect from them.

Monthly check-in

1. Open the **Monthly check-in** card.
2. Choose **On track**, **Slow** or **Blocked** and add a note (required if slow or blocked).
3. Press **Send check-in**. You can update it during the month. You get a reminder on the 25th if you have not checked in.

> **Why it matters** Your supervisors are notified when you report Slow or Blocked, and the PGC is told when you report Blocked, so help can reach you early.

Supervisor progress reviews

Your supervisors periodically record a review with a progress rating (Excellent, Good, Satisfactory, Unsatisfactory) and a recommendation (Continue, Concern, At risk) with comments. You are notified and can read them in the **Supervisor progress reviews** card.

9. Examiners and final stages

Examiners

The HoD appoints an **Internal Examiner** (from another department, stage 9) and an **External Examiner** (from another university, stage 13). Supervisors cannot be your examiners. Examiner scores are recorded by the department; you receive the examiner's comments and report when available.

Corrections and completion

1. At stage 14 upload the **External Examiner Comments** file, your **comment-by-comment response** and your **final corrected version**.
2. At stage 15 your supervisors endorse; the Inspector approve the Final Correction.
3. At stage 16 submit the signed copies to the PGC. Your journey is then complete.

10. Asking questions and making requests

Choosing the right channel

Use	For
Messages	Day-to-day conversation with your supervisors
Inquiries	General questions and requests to the PGC / HoD
Requests	A formal supervisor change or a stage extension
Feedback thread	Comments about one specific submission

Send an inquiry

1. Open **Inquiries**, choose a **Category**, write a short **Subject** and your **Message** (10–2000 characters).
2. Optionally attach one file (PDF, Word, PNG or JPG, up to 5 MB) and press **Send inquiry**.
3. When the PGC or HoD replies it becomes *Answered* and you are notified. Open it to read the conversation, send a follow-up, or press **Mark as resolved**.

> **Limit** You can have at most 10 unresolved inquiries at a time. A closed inquiry cannot be reopened by you; send a new one.

Make a formal request

1. In **Requests** on the Dashboard choose the **Type** (supervisor change or stage extension).
2. Explain your reason (at least 10 characters) and press **Send request**.
3. The PGC or HoD decides; the decision and note appear in your Requests table.

11. Programme calendar

Programme Calendar

The **Programme Calendar** page shows the monthly programme sessions (seminars and defences), deadlines and, where relevant to you, scheduled supervision meetings. Use the month arrows to move around and **Today** to return to the current month. The PGC publishes and updates the sessions; they can be cancelled or restored.

- Click an event to see its date, time, venue and notes.
- Use the calendar download button to add events to Google Calendar, Outlook or your phone (.ics file).

12. Troubleshooting and FAQ

Common questions

Question	Answer
I cannot resubmit a document.	Only *Rejected*, *Changes Requested* or *Draft* submissions can be resubmitted. Check the status in My Submissions.
The portal says my stage rule blocks the submission.	Some documents are only accepted at certain stages. See the document table in chapter 6. If your stage is wrong, request a stage update.
My Word file shows format problems.	Open the formatting result, fix the margins and citations, and resubmit. Left margin must be 4.0 cm and the others 2.5 cm.
I did not get the sign-in email.	Check spam. Ask the PGC to reset your password; a new one-time password will be sent.

Question	Answer
My supervisor is not assigned yet.	The PGC assigns supervisors at stage 3. Send an Inquiry if you have waited too long.
I want to change my supervisor or extend my stage.	Use a formal Request (not Messages).

13. Quick reference

Where to find things

I want to…	Go to…
See my stage and what is next	Dashboard → PG Journey and “To move on from this stage”
Upload a document	My Submissions → New Submission
Message my supervisors	Dashboard → Message my supervisors
Say how my month is going	Dashboard → Monthly check-in
Add points to a meeting agenda	Dashboard → Supervision Meetings
Ask the department a question	Inquiries
See deadlines and seminars	Programme Calendar
Change password or email	Help & FAQ → My account